German Idealism Reading Group

Columbia University

Faculty Sponsor: Axel Honneth

Meetings: Wednesdays, 4-6pm in 302 Philosophy Hall

Topic: Hegel's *Philosophy of Right*.

Description: We'll work through Hegel's *Philosophy of Right*, his major text on social-political philosophy and ethics. Topics discussed in this book include the will, property, contract, punishment, responsibility, duty, conscience, evil, the family, love, the economy, justice system, police, the state, law, sovereignty, legislative power, executive power, and history.

Schedule of Readings

Week **Reading(s)**

1 The Project of the Philosophy of Right

- "Preface" (pp. 9-23)
- "Introduction": §1-3 (pp. 25-34)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Objective Spirit": §483-486 (pp. 217-218)

2 The Structure of the Will

- "Introduction": §4-32 (pp. 35-62)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Psychology": §469-482 (pp. 206-215)

3 Persons and Property

- "Abstract Right": §34-40 (pp. 67-72)
- "Property": §41-64 (pp. 73-94)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Right": §488-491 (p. 220)

4 Exchange and Contract

- "Property": §65-§71 (pp. 95-103)
- "Contract" (pp. 104-114)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Right": §492-495 (p. 221)

5 Wrongdoing and the Moral Standpoint

- "Wrong" (pp. 115-132)
- "Morality" (pp. 135-142)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Right": §496-502 (p. 222-223)
- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Morality": §503 (p. 224)

6 The Structure of Moral Agency

- "Purpose and Responsibility" (pp. 143-146)
- "Intention and Welfare" (pp. 147-156)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Morality": §504-509 (pp. 224-226)

7 Conscience and Evil

- "The Good and Conscience": §129-138 (pp. 157-186)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Morality": §510 (p. 226-227)
- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §513-517 (p. 228-229)

8 The Concept of Ethical Life

- "Ethical Life" (pp. 189-198)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §518-523 (pp. 229-230)

9 The Family

- "The Family" (pp. 199-219)
- "Civil Society": §182-188 (pp. 220-226)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §524-530 (pp. 232-233)

10 The Economy

- "Civil Society": §189-229 (pp. 227-259)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §531-534 (pp. 234-236)

11 The Limits of the Market Economy

- "Civil Society": §230-256 (pp. 259-274)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §535-540 (pp. 236-240)

12 The Nature of the State

- "The State": §257-274 (pp. 275-313)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §541-542 (pp. 240-242)

13 The Division of Powers

- "The State": §275-320 (pp. 313-359)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §543-544 (pp. 242-245)

14 International Relations and World-History

- "The State": §321-360 (pp. 359-380)

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, *Philosophy of Spirit*. "Ethical Life": §545-552 (pp. 245-256)